global perception most profoundly has been the Indian stance during the Covid pandemic. By providing vaccines to a 100 partners and medicines and materials to 150 nations, India demonstrated an altogether different level of global responsibility. The accrued goodwill has clearly helped define its profile at a time when the world is in transition.

In international cooperation, a lot depends on the willingness to walk the talk. For decades, we were known for partnering with other nations in their development efforts, mostly through training and exchanges but also, on occasion, through projects. In the last decade, this development has been significantly scaled up. There has been a visible expansion in lines of credit, grant assistance, capability building, infrastructure and economic projects as well as human resources enhancement.

But more than this scale, what has really changed is the effectiveness of delivery. Monitored continuously and supervised strongly, long-pending projects were brought to successful conclusion and new ones undertaken with greater professionalism. Connectivity, socio-economic facilities, logistics and energy in our immediate neighbourhood have been particular beneficiaries. Post-earthquake projects in Nepal and infrastructure in Mauritius are prominent examples of the enhanced quality of delivery. Despite the Covid challenges, India was also able to keep most of its commitments made to African nations as part of the India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS).

During this period, the footprint of India’s international partnerships has also expanded perceptibly. It now ranges from renewable energy in the Pacific to community projects in the Caribbean. It could be the refinery in Mongolia, the Metro Express in Mauritius, a textile factory in Kenya or water supply in Tanzania, many India-supported endeavours have been game-changers for the partner countries.

A more vigorous India has been able to forge new relationships that recognize its growing value. An obvious example is the Quad, which has facilitated other Indo-Pacific engagements in domains like technology, supply chains, education, maritime security, etc. When it came to Eurasia, India’s inclusion in the SCO in 2017 underlined its salience to that grouping’s agenda. During this period, membership of export control regimes like Missile Technology Control Regime, Australia Group and Wassenaar Arrangement were as significant as plurilateral initiatives led by India, especially on sustainability. These memberships also spoke of a